

THE EXTERIOR

In common with most modern Schempp-Hirth gliders, the Duo Discus is constructed of fiberglass-reinforced plastic (GFRP) surrounding a steel tube frame. This structure results in a very strong airframe that offers the crew substantial levels of safety in the event of an accident, yet the GFRP enables the large airframe to weigh in at just 904lb(410kg) when empty. The composite structure also enables designers to create a sculpted and stylish appearance, and ensures that the Duo Discus is one of the most attractive gliders on the market. The airframe boasts a T-tail for elevator authority and a retractable monowheel undercarriage with wing tip stabilizers.

1. Logo from the 1990s 2. Eyelet/hook for aero-towing 3. Direct Vision (DV) panel 4. Air brakes on upper surface of wing 5. TE (Total Energy) Compensation Probe (on tail) linked to variometer 6. Port wing tip stabilizer wheel 7. Main undercarriage monowheel (retractable) 8. Pitot tube (on tail) 9. Winch-launch cable hook 10. Canopy stay 11. 65-ft (20-m) wing with winglets 12. Water ballast spill holes cover 13. Rudder controls

